IPRO
GOVERNANCE | INSIGHTS | DISCOVERY

Search Syntax Quick Reference(1 of 3)

Basic Search Operators

You can combine or restrict full-text search terms by using the Boolean operators listed in the following table.

Search for...	Syntax	Examples
All words or phrases listed	and	smith **and** deficit **and** profit
Any of the words or phrases listed	or	profit **or** deficit **or** revenue.
Records that do *not* include a particular word or phrase	and not or not not	profit **and not** deficit profit **or not** deficit **not** profit

- All indexed words in all indexed fields (that you have right to view) of all records are examined.
- Parentheses help clarify a search; they can also be used with field names.

Field Specific Search

This is a basic text search limited to a specific field.

Search for...	Syntax	Examples
Records in which specified field contains specified term or phrase	contains	to **contains** (jane smith) to **contains** (smith or hall)
Records in which specified field does not contain specified term or phrase	contains *? and not	author **contains (*? and not** brenner)

- Field searching applies when field is included in the full-text index.
- Wildcards can be used in field searches.

Wildcards

In addition to Boolean search operators, other basic search syntax includes phrases and wildcards.

Search for....	Syntax	Examples
Data containing zero or more characters in the asterisk's location	*	autorao* phi*p
Data containing a single character in the question mark's location	?	su?anne
Data containing a single digit in the equal sign's location	=	ABC===2

Phrase

To search for a phrase, enter the phrase the way it normally appears. Use quotation marks around a phrase to ensure that connector words (and, or, not) are interpreted as part of the phrase.

Syntax	Examples
space or " " (quotation marks)	gene summer "profit and deficit"

Extracted Text

Use the following syntax to limit a search to text in extracted text files (as opposed to fields).

Syntax	Description
//TEXT contains (term)	Search extracted text for the specified term or phrase. For example: //TEXT contains (limited resources)
//TEXT contains (term1 or term2)	Search extracted text for either of the specified terms or phrases. For example: //TEXT contains (solar or wind)
//TEXT contains (term1 and term2)	Search extracted text for both of the specified terms or phrases. For example: //TEXT contains (electricity and gas)

Date Field Search

Specify the field containing the date(s) of interest, such as creation date. For long or complex field names (particularly containing spaces), enclose the name in parentheses. See examples in the following table.

- Enter a date in the format YYYYMMDD, regardless of the format that displays in the case. For example, the case may show 12/3/2000; you would enter 20001203.
- If required, enter a range in the format (date1~~date2), as in (20000101~~20001231).
- If combining a date search with another search, use parentheses to enclose the field name and date (or date range). See the example in the following table. You can search for a date alone in a DateTime field by using the * (asterisk) wildcard, for example: 20101130*.

What to Find	Syntax
All records that contain a Creation Date of December 22, 2008	creation date contains (20081222)
All records that contain a Sent Date other than December 22, 2008	sent date contains (*? and not 20081222)
All records that contain a Creation Date between January 1, 2001 and December 31, 2008	creation date contains (20010101~~20081231)
All records that contain an email address and a 2013 Sent Date	jsmith@myco.com and (sent date contains (20130101~~20131231))

Proximity Search

A type of full-text search that specifies how close two (or more) words must be to each other in order to qualify as a search result.

Except for first- or last-word proximity searches, proximity searching spans fields; results may occasionally be unexpected.

Operator	Search for..	Syntax	Examples
Within	Records in which two terms are within a specific distance of one another, in any order:	w /	profit w/5 loss profit w/5 deficit
Not within	Words that are no closer than a specified number of words.	not w/	profit not w/5 loss
Before	A word that precedes another word by a specified amount	pre/	profit pre/5 loss profit pre/5 deficit
First-word proximity	A word that is near the first word in a field by a specified amount	w/# xfirstword	profit w/5 xfirstword
Last-word proximity	A word that is near the last word in a field by a specified amount	w/# xlastword	profit w/5 xlastword

Approximate Strings

Type	Search for..	Syntax	Examples
Fuzzy	Terms that are a close, but not an exact match. Useful for searching text fields in which some characters may not have been interpreted correctly by an OCR engine.	%	aut%%mobile
Phonic	Terms that sound similar but are spelled differently	#	#smith
Stemming	Terms and all words beginning with the root form of the word	~	operation~

- Although you should use Advanced Search with the Fuzzy option for most fuzzy searches, you can specify fuzziness selectively using the percent character, %. The number of % characters included determines the number of differences that will be ignored during a search. The position of the % characters determines how many letters at the start of the word have to match exactly

Multi-Part Search Expression

- Search expressions can include several parts. Operations are performed in sequence from left to right.
- If you use more than one connector (and, or, not, etc.), use parentheses to precisely indicate the search.
- The use of nested parentheses is supported, but as with mathematical expressions, take care to ensure correct construction.

Example	Description
(annual or profit) and deficit	This search first creates a set of documents containing either *annual* OR *profit* (in any field) and then reduces that subset to only those documents that ALSO contain the word *deficit.*
annual or (profit and deficit)	This search first creates a set of documents containing *annual* and then adds to that set any documents containing both *profit* AND *deficit.*
(jones or (smith and hall)) and not (carpenter or blakely)	This search first creates a set of documents containing *jones* and then adds to that set any documents containing both *smith* AND *hall.* It then removes from the set any records containing either *carpenter* OR *blakely.*
⊘ (profit and deficit) w/10 (smith and jones)	**DO NOT USE!** This is an example of an ambiguous search. Ambiguity can particularly occur when the W/ connector is used in a muti-part search. In general, at least one of the two expressions connected by W/ must be a single word or phrase or a group of words and phrases connected by OR.